

Strategic fit defines the buy-versus-build choice

DECISION LENS	BUY · STANDARD CAPABILITIES	BUILD · DIFFERENTIATED CAPABILITIES
Strategic fit	Common market needs; speed to value matters	Distinctive workflows; control data and experience
Constraints	Fit gaps can force process compromise	Own the product roadmap and change priorities
Ownership	Licensing and vendor roadmaps constrain change	Durable product and engineering capability; ongoing maintenance
AI economics	Lower planning and legacy run costs inform the choice	Faster coding, testing and migration lower build costs

AI reduces discovery, implementation and legacy maintenance costs. Choose for strategic fit, differentiation and ownership.

Connect strategy to sustained value

Connected subphases turn business intent into controlled delivery and sustained value.

FOUR CONTINUOUS THREADS

Every phase decision

- Business value and economics
- Process and experience
- People and change
- Technology and delivery

01 Rationalize

Thesis alignment
Outcomes and questions

Assessment
Work, risk and dependencies

Reimagine
Test future experiences

Plan
Economics and first wave

02 Build

Design
Processes and prototypes

Build
Approved bounded increments

Validate
Parity, controls, acceptance

Transition
Data, people and operations

03 Sustain

Operate
Service, security and cost

Evolve
Knowledge, backlog, value

Decommission
Retire dependencies and cost